

Filename: README21
Document Date: March 17, 1998
Revision Date: January 28, 2003

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GENERAL INFORMATION

Assets and Health Dynamics Among the Oldest-Old (AHEAD) is a national survey of community-based Americans born in 1923 or earlier. It is sponsored by the National Institute on Aging. The first wave of data was collected from October 1993 through July 1994 by the Survey Research Center, Institute for Social Research, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, Michigan. Some masking has been done: All names, health card numbers, social security numbers, birth dates, PSUs, geography (except U.S. Census division and region) have been removed, and occupation has been bracketed to a summary code.

The AHEAD public release data are accessible upon user consent to abiding by data dissemination restrictions spelled out in the "Conditions of Use Memorandum" (which you agree to when registering via the Web) to protect confidentiality of respondents.

DOCUMENTATION FILES

Previously the questionnaire was provided as both Word and Adobe PDF files. Most of the codebook documentation was provided as both WordPerfect and ASCII text files. We are now providing both the questionnaire and codebook documentation only as Adobe PDF files. The contents of these files are detailed below. The codebook section files contain marginals or means for each variable. The data file in which the variables appear is noted in parenthesis.

Uncompressed questionnaire files from a93qn.zip	Uncompressed codebook files from a93cb.zip	Contents
B01_TOC.PDF	CODB-TBC.PDF	Table of contents
B02_PREF.PDF		Preface
B03_CS.PDF		Coversheet
	AHINTRO.PDF	Introduction (or data description)
B04_A.PDF	CODB-A.PDF	Demographics (BR21)

Uncompressed questionnaire files from a93qn.zip	Uncompressed codebook files from a93cb.zip	Contents
B05_B.PDF	CODB-B.PDF	Health Status (BR21)
B06_PC.PDF	CODB-PC.PDF	Cognition Proxy Interview (BR21)
B07_C.PDF	CODB-C.PDF	Cognition Self Interview (BR21)
B08_D.PDF	CODB-D.PDF	Family Structure (BR21, BHH21, BOP21)
B09_E.PDF	CODB-E.PDF	Health Care Use and Costs; Help (BR21, BHH21, BHP21)
B10_F.PDF	CODB-F.PDF	Housing (BHH21)
B11_G.PDF	CODB-G.PDF	Productive Activities (BR21)
B12_H.PDF	CODB-H.PDF	Expectations (BR21)
B13_J.PDF	CODB-J.PDF	Income (BR21, BHH21)
B14_K.PDF	CODB-K.PDF	Assets (BHH21)
B15_R.PDF	CODB-R.PDF	Health Insurance (BR21, BHH21)
B16_MODS.PDF	CODB-MOD.PDF	Modules (BR21)
B17_PROB.PDF		Problems
	APNDXA-B.PDF	Appendices A (Expanded Codes) and B (Recodes for Creating Expanded Person Variables)
	APNDX-C.PDF	Appendix C: Technical Description of AHEAD Survey Sample Design
	CHANGES.PDF	Codebook and dataset changes.
	CHANGES2003.PDF	Changes to identification variables and special missing data values (new Jan 2003)
	CONTENTS.PDF	Variable dictionary (Proc Contents output from SAS, revised Jan 2003)

DATA FILES

Four sets of data and associated program statement files -- household, respondent, other person and helper -- are provided. The household and respondent level files are provided as just one household file and one respondent file instead of, as previously, both as a combined file and also as separate section files. The table below lists the number of records and number of variables in each of the files.

Each data file comes with associated SPSS, SAS or Stata program statements to read the data and handle missing data. Files containing

- o SPSS statements are named with a .SPS extension
- o SAS statements are named with a .SAS extension
- o Stata statements are named with .DO and .DCT extensions

Missing data statements are included. See *changes2003.pdf* for more details about special missing data codes.

The program statement files are named beginning with the same prefix as the corresponding data file. For example, SAS statements in the file BHH21.SAS go with the BHH21.DA data file.

File Name	Number of records	Number of variables	
		New	Old
BHH21	6,047	678	678
BHH21_D	6,047		70
BHH21_E	6,047		50
BHH21_F	6,047		118
BHH21_J	6,047		274
BHH21_K	6,047		144
BHH21_R	6,047		87
BR21	8,222	637	638
BR21_A	8,222		59
BR21_B	8,222		91
BR21_C	8,222		75
BR21_D	8,222		43
BR21_E	8,222		170
BR21_G	8,222		97
BR21_H	8,222		50
BR21_J	8,222		41
BR21_MOD	8,222		187
BR21_PC	8,222		52
BR21_R	8,222		43
BOP21	17,424	137	137
BHP21	3,160	21	20

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If you have questions or concerns that are not adequately covered here, in the documentation files or on our Web site, or if you have any comments, please contact us. We will do our best to provide answers.

AHEAD public release data and additional information about the study are available on the Health and Retirement Study Web site. As of 9/1/2002, the URL is:

<http://hrsonline.isr.umich.edu/>

If you need to contact us, you may do so by one of the methods listed below.

Internet: [Help Desk](#) at our Web site

E-mail: <mailto:hrsquest@isr.umich.edu>

Postal service:

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